

1642

ENGLISH CIVIL WAR BEGINS

Stuart king Charles I came into confrontation with many of his subjects in England and Scotland over taxation and religious issues. He tried to rule without parliament and was seen as favouring Catholicism. In 1642, the king and the English parliament raised armies and embarked on a civil war, fighting their first pitched battle at Edgehill in October. With neither side achieving a clear victory, a long conflict set in.

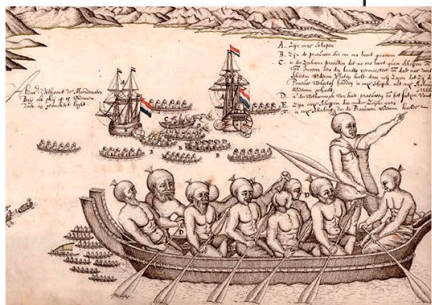


1640

1640 Portugal wins independence after

throwing off Spanish rule

▽ Dutch drawing of the Maori, 1642



1642

DUTCH REACH NEW ZEALAND

The explorer and merchant Abel Tasman was sent by the Dutch East India Company to explore the South Pacific. In December 1642, his men became the first Europeans to sight New Zealand. Anchoring off South Island they clashed with Maori warriors in canoes. The contact was fleeting. Europeans did not return to New Zealand until 1769.

1643 Louis XIV

becomes king of France at the age of four, with his mother Anne of Austria as regent



◁ Lobsang Gyatso, the Fifth Dalai Lama

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DALAI LAMA UNIFIES TIBET

In the early 1600s, Tibet was torn by conflict between rival Buddhist sects and warring tribal factions. In 1642, under the Fifth Dalai Lama Lobsang Gyatso, an effective government was formed in Lhasa, ending the civil strife. Lobsang Gyatso's successors ruled into the 20th century.